

September 5, 2026

Dear Dr. Yang (editor),

Please find the focused revision of *RankCloak Conceals the Surface Form of Synthetic Cryptographic Artifacts in Language Model Generated Text* (submission 0170c7b2-1065-4344-a5d5-b839b51ac22c). Thank you and Reviewer 2 for the constructive second assessment. We retained the previous revisions and completed all the additional experiments requested.

RankCloak addresses an artifact-specific problem, transforming recognizable synthetic cryptographic artifacts into context-dependent token choices so their hexadecimal, UUID, base64, nonce, tag, ciphertext-like, or signature surface form is not directly exposed in generated cover text, while an authorized receiver reconstructs the artifact under a shared protocol configuration. Steganalytic classification is a distinct case study. The new results show that current detectors can often identify encoded covers, but the detection does not itself reveal or recover the concealed cryptographic artifacts.

The revision adds strict pre-feature deduplication with zero leakage under the declared audit, 250 human-authored secondary controls, genuine leave-one-model-family-out tests, data-adaptive text detectors, an exact-model-aware attacker, and validation-frozen low-FPR analysis with exact false-positive counts. It also adds entropy-gated embedding and a matched comparison of approximately 4-bit and 8-bit quantized versions of the same pinned Qwen model, including recovery and cross-quantization detection. The complete declared computational sets and their validation finished successfully without generation execution failures. The paper does not claim a cryptographic secrecy proof, universal undetectability, or robustness under every text transformation.

The existing GitHub and Zenodo statements remain truthful. Final V3 Zenodo synchronization, archived-version confirmation, and DOI wording synchronization are listed as manual pre-submission steps and are not represented as already complete.

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,

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